

version. The new kernel shares many components with Windows 8, so that applications can be easily ported between the two platforms. The new NT kernel adds support for multi-core CPUs of up to 64 cores, larger displays till 1280x768 resolution along with a lot of other hardware support like support for MicroSD cards.

Windows Phone 7 applications use XNA (a WP7 specific version of Silverlight) while Windows Phone 8 will support running of managed code through the Common Language Runtime similar to Windows 8 as opposed to *the .NET* Compact Framework used in the previous version. Windows Phone 8 also supports native C and C++ libraries and by extension allows the apps to be written in native languages. This OS is exclusive to smartphones, the tablets run either the fully-featured Windows 8 or a somewhat stunted Windows RT.



Windows Phone 8

Windows Phone 7 devices are being produced by LG, Samsung, HTC, Dell, Acer, Alcatel and ZTE, Nokia. Windows Phone 8 devices are currently being produced by Nokia, HTC, and Samsung. Microsoft places stringent requirement on manufacturers for it's operating system with only the older Windows Phone 7 supporting slower processors and memory. This ensures that all devices in the same price range perform equally well. Microsoft will support Windows Phone 7 till September 2014.

## Other OSes

There are a couple of other operating systems which are usually released with much pomp and pageantry in PR blitzkrieg but they usually fade to ignominy when faced with the unrelenting Android juggernaut. Symbian is one such example, championed by Nokia it was the most used smartphone operating system till 2010 when Android caught up. Nokia has now outsourced the maintenance of the OS to Accenture, which has vowed to support it till 2016. Nokia PureView 808 was the last Symbian phone to hit the market. Bada is another such operating system, it was being developed by Samsung to be used in the low-end feature phones but it has stopped it's development and moved the development team to Tizen, another open source mobile operating system. Jolla and webOS are